BUSINESS PLAN · 2026

PreMeet

Brief yourself before the meeting. In two minutes, not two hours.

A website that turns a name into a meeting-ready briefing deck — research area, funded work, photo, and ranked collaboration talking points. Business plan, deployment, pricing, and go-to-market.

WEDGE: UNIVERSITY SCHOLARS EXPANSION: ADJACENT VERTICALS UNIT ECONOMICS: §5

THE PROBLEM · 02

The cold meeting burns the scarcest resource in the university: expert time.

You have 30 minutes with a visiting scholar, a prospective co-author, or a program officer — and no time to read their work. So the meeting starts with ten minutes of catch-up, or skips the substance entirely.

The cost is real, and absent from any budget line.

- A faculty consulting hour benchmarks at **$85–$360**; a research assistant at **$22–$35/hr**.
- A competent pre-meeting dossier takes an RA **2–4 hours** — **$70–$1,400** of staff time, and a day's lead time.
- The alternative today is a **DIY LLM prompt**: 30–60 minutes of effort, no sources, inconsistent, no grant data.
- The meeting load is **rising** — grant-driven and interdisciplinary work means more cross-field meetings every year.

THE PRODUCT · 03

A name in. A brief you can read on the walk over.

IN **A name** — plus optional institution, URL, ORCID, or a pasted agenda.

OUT **A 9–13 slide brief** — profile & headshot, research threads, funded portfolio, recognition, and **ranked collaboration talking points** with a recommended opener.

OUT **PDF + share link**, with a **source link on every claim** and a "verify before you rely on it" banner.

NOT Not a CRM, not a meeting-notes tool, not a people-search database. It is the **pre-meeting synthesis artifact**.

The whole value is *saved time* and a *better meeting* — an artifact, not another tab of raw data.

MVP ships: name → brief, sources, PDF export, and a cache of every person generated.

WHY NOW & THE WEDGE · 04

The compute flipped, the data is free, and nobody owns the niche.

- **Compute cost collapse.** Synthesis now runs for cents on mid-tier models ($2/$10 per M tokens) and returns good prose. The economics flipped.
- **Open structured data is free.** OpenAlex, ORCID, Crossref, Semantic Scholar, NIH RePORTER, NSF Awards API — identity, publications, and **grants** at no cost.
- **The hard part moved.** Finding data is solved; *synthesising it legibly* is the job. That is exactly what a model does well now.
- **No incumbent.** Sales-intel tools serve B2B sales; academic databases serve raw data; meeting tools record *after*. The pre-meeting person-brief for academics is open.

1.5M+
US FACULTY (BEACHHEAD)

$85–360
FACULTY CONSULTING HR

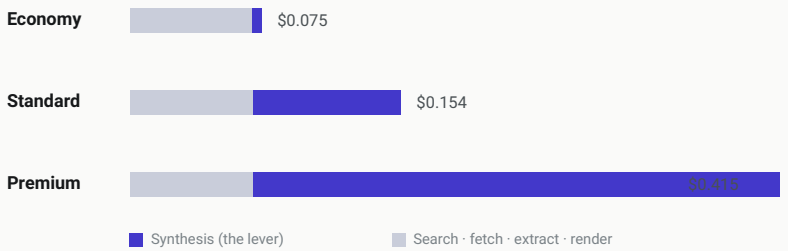
2–4 hrs
TODAY'S RA COST/DOSSIER

< 2 min
PREMEET TIME TO BRIEF

UNIT ECONOMICS I · 05

One brief costs 8¢ to 42¢. Synthesis is the only real lever.

COST COMPONENT	ECONOMY	STANDARD	PREMIUM
Web search (6–10 queries)	$0.006	$0.006	$0.010
Page fetch / extract	$0.048	$0.048	$0.080
LLM extraction (cheap)	$0.010	$0.010	$0.015
LLM synthesis	**$0.005**	**$0.084**	**$0.300**
Render + storage	$0.006	$0.006	$0.010
COGS / brief	**≈$0.08**	**≈$0.15**	**≈$0.42**



> Flagship synthesis costs **60×** economy synthesis on the same pipeline. Everything else is noise — optimise it once, then expose synthesis tier as the quality dial.

Rates: Opus-5-class $5/$25 · Sonnet-5-class $2/$10 · economy ~$0.15/$0.60 per M tokens · Serper ~$0.001/query · Tavily extract $0.008/credit · self-hosted render ~$0.005/doc. Blended (70/20/10) ≈ **$0.16/brief**.

UNIT ECONOMICS II · 06

Pricing is not cost recovery. It is three other trade-offs.

Because COGS is 8¢–42¢, any sane price clears cost by a wide margin. The binding constraints are payment friction, quality-vs-churn, and abuse control.

A · FEE FRICTION ON MICRO-CHARGES

ONE-OFF PRICE	STRIPE FEE	NET
$1	**$0.33**	**$0.67 (33% lost)**
$3	$0.39	$2.61
$5	$0.45	$4.55
$9	**$0.56**	$8.44

2.9% + $0.30. → **Never sell a $1–2 one-off.** Floor ~$5; $9 is the sweet spot; small buyers go to credit packs/subscriptions.

B · QUALITY VS. CHURN — THE REAL COST

A cheap brief costs little in compute and a lot in churn. **Spend on synthesis by default** (standard, 15¢); make economy the explicit "draft" option, never the silent default. Saving 10¢ against a $15 subscription is a losing trade.

C · ABUSE — UNBOUNDED COST FROM ONE ACTOR

Small per-brief cost × uncapped usage = unlimited exposure. **Finite credits, per-user COGS metering, hard overages.** See next slide.

UNIT ECONOMICS III · 07

The "unlimited" trap: one power user destroys the cohort margin.

PLAN	USAGE / MO	COGS	GROSS MARGIN
$19/mo "unlimited"	20 briefs	$3	84%
$19/mo "unlimited"	100 briefs	$15	21%
$19/mo "unlimited"	500 briefs	$75	−295%
$15/mo, 20-brief cap	20 (cap)	$3	80% (bounded)

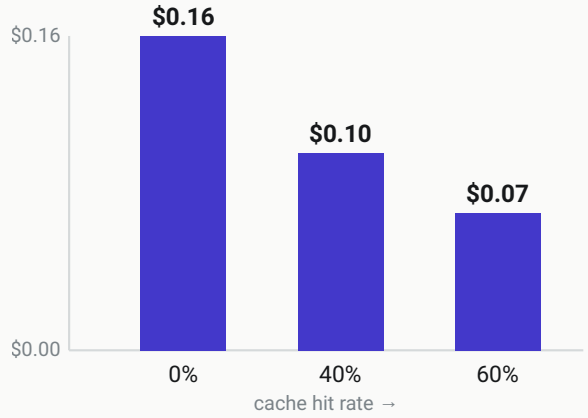
> A cap does not just protect the floor — it **converts an unbounded liability into a bounded one**. This single rule (no unlimited generation) is what makes the whole portfolio's margin predictable. Overage is priced at a multiple of COGS ($1.50–$2.00/brief) so the power user is **profitable per unit**, not subsidised.

UNIT ECONOMICS IV · 08

The cache is the moat — and it drives acquisition to zero.

Most briefs are about *recurring subjects* — famous scholars, deans, program officers, frequent collaborators. The first brief about a person costs $0.15. Every later brief about the same person costs **~$0.005** (re-format from the cached fact base; no re-research).

- At a **40% cache-hit rate**, blended COGS falls from $0.16 to **~$0.10**.
- At **60%**, it falls to **~$0.07** — a structural cost advantage a new entrant cannot copy without the corpus.
- It also makes the **public profile pages** essentially free to serve — the SEO flywheel.



PRICING · 09

Freemium land-and-expand, with the institution as the expand.

PLAN	PRICE	BRIEFS/MO	DEPTH	WORST-CASE COGS	GROSS MARGIN
Free	$0	2	standard	$0.30	acquisition
Pro	$15/mo	20	standard	$3.00	**80%**
Research	$39/mo	60	incl. premium	$12.00	**69%**
Department	$199/mo	300 pooled	mixed	$45.00	**77%**
One-off	$9 each	1	premium	$0.42	**91%***
University site license	$3k–25k/yr	fair-use	mixed	—	high ACV

*net of Stripe. Worst-case = every brief at the tier's depth; **typical** usage (5 briefs on Pro) runs ~**95%** margin. Annual = ~2 months free. The Department and site-license tiers are where the business gets comfortable — high ACV, low support, and the buyer (research office / VPR / library) has a budget for exactly this.

BREAK-EVEN · 10

~250 Pro-equivalents, or 19 Department plans.

Cash fixed cost at early stage ≈ **$3,000/mo** (hosting, search/PDF subscriptions, email/auth/analytics, a part-time support contractor).

> Contribution per Pro user ≈ $15 × 0.95 (net of Stripe) − $0.75 (typical COGS) ≈ **$12.10/mo**. CAC target **< $50** (organic/SEO-led) → payback < 5 months.

COVER FIXED COST WITH…	COUNT	NOTE
Pro subscribers	~250	$12.10 contribution each
Department plans	~19	≈$170 net each
University site licenses	1–2	covers the run-rate alone

$12.10
CONTRIBUTION / PRO / MO

~250
BREAK-EVEN PRO USERS

< $50
CAC TARGET

< 5 mo
PAYBACK TARGET

DEPLOYMENT · 11

Concierge first, then self-serve, then institutional.

PHASE	WINDOW	DELIVERABLE	SUCCESS GATE	COST CONTROLS
0 · Concierge MVP	0–2 mo	Run the pipeline manually for 20–50 faculty; charge $9–19	≥5 pay; NPS ≥40	manual
1 · Private beta	3–5 mo	Self-serve, freemium, Pro plan	100 users, 20 paying	COGS meter + kill-switch
2 · GA	6–9 mo	Public launch, Department plan, SEO pages live	300–500 paying, organic >50%	model router + cache
3 · Institutional	10–12 mo	First university site license; adjacent-vertical research	1 license; $10k MRR	per-account COGS budgets

Stack: Next.js on Vercel · Postgres (Neon) · job queue (Inngest/Trigger.dev — generation is 60–150s async) · Redis + Postgres cache · S3/Vercel Blob · Gotenberg/Playwright render · Stripe Billing · Resend · PostHog · OpenRouter model layer. **Phase 0 is not optional** — it validates willingness-to-pay and seeds the cache before a line of product code is written.

The SEO flywheel is both the cost moat and the acquisition engine.

Every public figure briefed can power a public, opt-out-able profile page — capturing high-intent long-tail searches ("who is X", "X research area", "prepare for a meeting with X") at near-zero marginal cost, served from cache. Content compounds; CAC trends to zero.

CHANNELS, IN PRIORITY ORDER

- **SEO / programmatic content** — profile pages + how-to guides. The compounding asset.
- **Conference presence** — SIGCSE, CSCW, CHI, ICSE, ASEE. Hook: "give us your next five meetings — we'll brief them free at the booth."
- **Research-office channel** — VPR, CTL, libraries, grant offices already buy tools *for* faculty. Shortest path to Department/site licenses.
- **Academic social** — X/Bluesky/Mastodon, LinkedIn. The "name in → brief out" demo GIF is inherently shareable.
- **Viral loop** — every brief carries a subtle mark and share link; the recipient is a qualified prospect.
- **Partnerships** — OpenAlex/ORCID/Semantic Scholar for credibility and data; university procurement as the enterprise motion.

> **Positioning line:** "Brief yourself before the meeting. In two minutes, not two hours."

The moat is the corpus and the data — not the model.

ALTERNATIVE	WHAT IT IS	WHY WE WIN
DIY ChatGPT / Claude	Free-ish, capable	No artifact, no sources, 30–60 min of effort
Sales intelligence	Clay, Clearbit, ZoomInfo	Wrong vertical, expensive, no academic data
Academic profiles	Scholar, ResearchGate, OpenAlex	Raw data, not a brief; hours of reading
Meeting assistants	Otter, Fireflies, Granola	They record *after*; we prepare *before*
A human research assistant	$22–35/hr, 2–4 hrs	$70–$1,400 and a day's lead time

> A competitor can copy the interface tomorrow; they cannot copy the **cache corpus**, the **grant + CV data integrations**, or the **SEO real estate**. Those compound — the LLM call does not.

The plan is sound if we control three things: accuracy, legality, and free-tier cost.

- **Accuracy** — source-link every claim, quality gate before charging, optional human-review tier.
- **Privacy / legality** — prefer open APIs, honour robots.txt, professional info only, opt-out + noindex, takedown SLA; no personality or personal inference.
- **Free-tier cost** — cap at 2/mo (≤$0.30/user exposure), per-user COGS meter, kill-switch.
- **Model cost drift** — model-agnostic layer, aggressive cache, pinned cheap default.
- **Quality → churn** — invest in the fact base, not the prose; let users pick the synthesis tier.
- **Incumbent copies the surface** — speed to the corpus and the SEO pages.

The ask: runway to Phase 2 — ~$150–250k for 12 months (founder + one engineer + tooling + conference travel), or the equivalent as a university-partnered pilot. **Start concierge. Ship the manual pipeline to 50 people before writing product code.**